

Poisoned Coffee Investigation

St Oakwood Primary, staff room incident

CASE REF: PC-2026-03

DOCUMENT: Suspect profiles (15)

DATE: Monday 17 March, morning of incident

CASE FILE OPENED

MONDAY 17 MARCH · ST OAKWOOD PRIMARY · PC-2026-03

Started like any other Monday. Year 6 in, Sports Day kit stacked in the hall, staff room kettle on since eight.

At 3:58pm Mr Thornton found Mr White slumped at his desk in the Year 6 corridor. Mr White had missed afternoon registration. Thornton rang 999. Doctors say someone poisoned him. He is in hospital and he is going to recover, but he was unconscious for hours.

Police think it was the coffee. Mr White filled his blue mug in the staff room at about 11:10, walked back to class, took two sips, and left the mug on the left corner of his desk. He never picked it up again.

Hot drinks get made in the staff room. Shared sugar bowl on the counter. Fridge, kettle, tray of mugs. Forensics photographed everything. Your class gets the paper files first; some photos arrive later in envelopes.

Reception logs who comes in. HR has heights from medicals, fingerprint types from safeguarding training, shoe sizes from the Sports Day order form. Fifteen names on the list. Everyone below gave a statement.

You work in pairs. Your teacher releases clues through the morning, in envelopes or on the board. Cross names off your own copy if you like. After each round the class board is the record that matters.

When a new clue lands, check it against height, fingerprint type, shoe size, and tread on each card. People sound sure of themselves and still get it wrong. Before lunch you will interview a few names and write down who you think did it.

Fifteen people on this list. One of them put something in that mug.

USING THIS PACK

Keep the pages together. Write on your copy, not the whiteboard. When you and your partner agree someone is out, tick Ruled out and scribble why.

Read all fifteen before the first clue drops. Note who might have been in the staff room.

New envelope or board clue? Stop. Run it against everyone you have left.

Talk in your pair, then with the class. Your teacher strikes names off the shared board.

Two suspects with the same shoe size? Keep both until something splits them.

You can only interview a few people later. Pick the ones you actually need.

Final accusation: one name, at least two reasons from the evidence. Not just a guess.

WHAT THE BOXES ON EACH CARD MEAN

Your teacher will hand out separate fingerprint and tread cards. Study each one, then circle the matching letter on this sheet.

HEIGHT

From the last school medical. CCTV is useless for faces here but the door frame has markers. If height comes up in a clue, compare the numbers.

FINGERPRINT

Circle one letter: A (arch — ridge goes up and over), L (loop — ridge curls round), or W (whorl — spiral). Your teacher has a separate card showing each person's print pattern.

SHOE SIZE

UK size from the Sports Day kit form. A wet footprint can show size even when you do not know who made it.

SOLE TREAD

Circle one letter: W (wave), C (circles), S (stripes), B (blocks), or D (dots). Your teacher has a separate card showing each person's sole pattern.

STATEMENT

What they told police first time round. Check it against the sign-in book, timetables, and anything else you get later.

PE Teacher

HEIGHT 5'8" SHOE SIZE UK 6

FINGERPRINT

A L W

SOLE TREAD

W C S B D

STATEMENT TO POLICE

Sports hall all morning. Hurdles, cones, the lot. I nipped to the staff room once for spare cones from the cupboard. Two minutes, in and out. I did not touch White's mug. Year 5 saw me crossing the playground with a stack of cones around eleven.

Investigation notes:

☐ Ruled out

MRS PATEL

SUSPECT 02 / 15

Dinner Lady

HEIGHT 5'1" SHOE SIZE UK 6

FINGERPRINT

A

L

W

SOLE TREAD

W

C

S

B

D

STATEMENT TO POLICE

Kitchen since half eight. Chef Dave was with me the whole time, prep for lunch. I went to reception once for a delivery. I did not go in the staff room. I do not drink coffee on shift.

Investigation notes:

☐ Ruled out

MRS SHARPE

SUSPECT 03 / 15

Deputy Head

HEIGHT 5'6" SHOE SIZE UK 7

FINGERPRINT

A

L

W

SOLE TREAD

W

C

S

B

D

STATEMENT TO POLICE

Governors in the head's office from nine. Mrs Adebayo took minutes. We did not leave except Mr Blake took a phone call in the corridor. I was not near Year 6 and I was not in the staff room.

Investigation notes:

☐ Ruled out

MISS FROST

SUSPECT 04 / 15

Supply Teacher

HEIGHT

5'5"

SHOE SIZE

UK 6

FINGERPRINT

A

L

W

SOLE TREAD

W

C

S

B

D

STATEMENT TO POLICE

Year 3, Room 8. Their teacher was off sick. Register at nine oh five, taught until break. I bring a flask. Nobody showed me where the staff room is.

Investigation notes:

☐ Ruled out

JAMIE

SUSPECT 05 / 15

Year 6 Work Experience Helper

HEIGHT

4'10"

SHOE SIZE

UK 4

FINGERPRINT

A

L

W

SOLE TREAD

W

C

S

B

D

STATEMENT TO POLICE

Library all morning with Mrs Hughes. Shelving, scanning, boring but I stayed put. Visitor badge from reception. I did not go upstairs. I heard about Mr White after three when everyone was talking in the corridor.

Investigation notes:

☐ Ruled out

MR THORNTON

SUSPECT 06 / 15

Caretaker

HEIGHT 6'0" SHOE SIZE UK 10

FINGERPRINT A L W

SOLE TREAD W C S B D

STATEMENT TO POLICE

Found Mr White at 3:58 and rang 999. Before that, boiler room fixing a leak. Key fob says I went in at 9:12. I walked past the staff room door once for tools. Did not go in. I liked Mr White.

Investigation notes:

☐ Ruled out

MRS CHEN

SUSPECT 07 / 15

Year 6 TA

HEIGHT 5'2" SHOE SIZE UK 5

FINGERPRINT A L W

SOLE TREAD W C S B D

STATEMENT TO POLICE

Lower maths in 6B while Mr White taught next door. At break I saw him come back with his blue mug. He looked fine. I made tea at ten fifteen in the little kitchenette on our floor, not the staff room.

Investigation notes:

☐ Ruled out

MR OKAFOR

SUSPECT 08 / 15

Year 5 Teacher

HEIGHT

6'1"

SHOE SIZE

UK 9

FINGERPRINT

A

L

W

SOLE TREAD

W

C

S

B

D

STATEMENT TO POLICE

Year 5 on the field till quarter to twelve. Cross-country for Sports Day. Thirty kids, two parents. I was outside. Grant grabbed cones from the storeroom while we were running. That is the only colleague I clocked.

Investigation notes:

☐ Ruled out

MR BLAKE

SUSPECT 09 / 15

Headteacher

HEIGHT

5'11"

SHOE SIZE

UK 8

FINGERPRINT

A

L

W

SOLE TREAD

W

C

S

B

D

STATEMENT TO POLICE

In my office with Mrs Sharpe and governors till lunch. Jane at reception logged the visitors. I stepped out once for a call, five minutes. No tea today because my PA was off sick.

Investigation notes:

☐ Ruled out

JANE MORRISON

SUSPECT 10 / 15

Office Admin

HEIGHT 5'0"

SHOE SIZE UK 4

FINGERPRINT ☐ ☐ ☐
A L W

SOLE TREAD ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐
W C S B D

STATEMENT TO POLICE

Reception from 8:15. Late children, parcels, phones. I run the sign-in book the police copied. Photocopier at half ten. Staff room is down the hall but I only go at lunch.

Investigation notes:

☐ Ruled out

MRS WALSH

SUSPECT 11 / 15

Year 4 Teacher

HEIGHT 5'7"

SHOE SIZE UK 6

FINGERPRINT ☐ ☐ ☐
A L W

SOLE TREAD ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐
W C S B D

STATEMENT TO POLICE

County training all morning. Register has my signature at nine and eleven at the training centre. I was not in the building. Tom Ellis emailed me slides at lunch because I missed briefing.

Investigation notes:

☐ Ruled out

MR KHAN

SUSPECT 12 / 15

Maths Teacher

HEIGHT 5'9" SHOE SIZE UK 8

FINGERPRINT

A L W

SOLE TREAD

W C S B D

STATEMENT TO POLICE

Numeracy course off site. Authority booked it months ago. Back at 1:20, badge scan proves it. Annoyed to miss Sports Day planning but I was not here when the coffee went on his desk.

Investigation notes:

☐ Ruled out

SOPHIE LANE

SUSPECT 13 / 15

Nursery TA

HEIGHT 5'0" SHOE SIZE UK 5

FINGERPRINT

A L W

SOLE TREAD

W C S B D

STATEMENT TO POLICE

Rang in sick at eight oh two. Chest infection. In bed. Partner will tell you. Pharmacy receipt at twenty to twelve in town if you want it. Not on site since Friday.

Investigation notes:

☐ Ruled out

GRACE OKONKWO

SUSPECT 14 / 15

Cleaner

HEIGHT

5'5"

SHOE SIZE

UK 7

FINGERPRINT

A

L

W

SOLE TREAD

W

C

S

B

D

STATEMENT TO POLICE

Shift starts at three when the kids leave. Agency app shows 14:58 at the gate. I clean the staff room every evening so I know the layout, but I was at home at eleven having lunch.

Investigation notes:

☐ Ruled out

TOM ELLIS

SUSPECT 15 / 15

IT Technician

HEIGHT

5'8"

SHOE SIZE

UK 9

FINGERPRINT

A

L

W

SOLE TREAD

W

C

S

B

D

STATEMENT TO POLICE

Server migration from home till noon. Logged in 9:03 from my house, IT have the IP. Badge in at 12:04. Teams call with Mr White at 8:50 about passwords. He sounded normal.

Investigation notes:

☐ Ruled out

Hand out 1st. After introducing the scenario. One pack per pair.

Forensic reference cards

Each card shows one person's fingerprint pattern and sole tread. Hand these out separately from the suspect bio sheets. Students study the visuals, then circle the matching letter on their bio (A / L / W for prints; W / C / S / B / D for tread).

MR GRANT

Suspect 01

PE Teacher

FINGERPRINT


Arch

SOLE TREAD


Wave

MRS PATEL

Suspect 02

Dinner Lady

FINGERPRINT


Arch

SOLE TREAD


Wave

MRS SHARPE

Suspect 03

Deputy Head

FINGERPRINT


Whorl

SOLE TREAD


Stripes

MISS FROST

Suspect 04

Supply Teacher

FINGERPRINT


Loop

SOLE TREAD


Stripes

JAMIE

Suspect 05

Year 6 Work Experience Helper

FINGERPRINT


Loop

SOLE TREAD


Dots

MR THORNTON

Suspect 06

Caretaker

FINGERPRINT


Whorl

SOLE TREAD


Blocks

MRS CHEN

Suspect 07

Year 6 TA

FINGERPRINT


Loop

SOLE TREAD


Wave

MR OKAFOR

Suspect 08

Year 5 Teacher

FINGERPRINT


Loop

SOLE TREAD


Stripes

MR BLAKE

Suspect 09

Headteacher

FINGERPRINT


Whorl

SOLE TREAD


Stripes

JANE MORRISONSuspect 10

Office Admin

FINGERPRINT



Loop

SOLE TREAD



Dots

MRS WALSHSuspect 11

Year 4 Teacher

FINGERPRINT



Loop

SOLE TREAD



Wave

MR KHANSuspect 12

Maths Teacher

FINGERPRINT



Whorl

SOLE TREAD



Blocks

SOPHIE LANESuspect 13

Nursery TA

FINGERPRINT



Whorl

SOLE TREAD



Circles

GRACE OKONKWOSuspect 14

Cleaner

FINGERPRINT



Loop

SOLE TREAD



Blocks

TOM ELLISSuspect 15

IT Technician

FINGERPRINT



Loop

SOLE TREAD



Stripes

TEACHER · HANDOUT 2 OF 6

Hand out 2nd. Straight after the suspect bios. Students match prints and treads onto their sheets.

Task 1 — Statement check

ENGLISH · SPAG ANALYSIS

CASE REF: PC-2026-03

DOCUMENT: Written statement analysis

DATE: Monday 17 March, morning of incident

Detectives noticed errors in Mr Grant's written statement. Read all four paragraphs carefully. Count each category below — your four answers make the access code (one digit each, in order).

Read all four paragraphs of the suspect statement.

Work through each count in order. Write one digit per box.

Put the four digits together and enter the code on the class iPad.

Tell your teacher when access is granted — then open the next envelope.

SUSPECT UNDER REVIEW

Mr Grant

PE Teacher

WRITTEN STATEMENT (AS FILED)

i was in the sports hall all monday morning with year five. we set up hurdles and bright orange cones becuase sports day was soon.

at about eleven i nipped to the staff room for spare cones. The visit was a quick trip. chef dave saw me carring a stack from storage.

The statement to police: never touched Mr White's blue mug. The gym stayed full all morning.

Sports day organisation went to Mr White, not the PE department. Staff did not put something in the hot coffee.

1

Missed capital letters

How many words should start with a capital letter but do not?

Answer:

2

Misspelled words

How many words are spelled incorrectly?

Answer:

3

Adjectives

How many adjectives appear in the whole statement?

Answer:

4

Pronouns

How many pronouns appear in the whole statement? (e.g. I, me, we, he, she, they, it)

Answer:

YOUR ACCESS CODE

Write your four answers in order — missed capitals, then misspellings, then adjectives, then pronouns.

1ST DIGIT

2ND DIGIT

3RD DIGIT

4TH DIGIT

Task 2 — Fingerprint counts

MATHS · ALGEBRA

CASE REF: PC-2026-03

DOCUMENT: Fingerprint tally worksheet

DATE: Monday 17 March, morning of incident

Forensics grouped partial prints from the staff room door. Solve each equation to find how many prints are in each group. Write each answer as a single digit — together they form the access code.

Solve each equation. Show your working in the space provided.

Each answer is a single digit (0–9). Write it in the answer box.

Line up your four answers to make the access code for the iPad.

Tell your teacher when access is granted — then open the next envelope.

QUESTION 1

Arch pattern prints

$$a + 8 = 15$$

Find a.

WORKING

Answer:

QUESTION 2

Loop pattern prints

$$4b = 32$$

Find b.

WORKING

Answer:

QUESTION 3**Smudged prints**

$$5c - 3 = 22$$

Find c.

WORKING

Answer:

QUESTION 4**Ruled-out whorl prints**

$$18 \div d = 2$$

Find d.

WORKING

Answer:

YOUR ACCESS CODE

Put your four answers in order — arch, loop, smudged, ruled out — to make a four-digit code.

ARCH

LOOP

SMUDGED

RULED OUT

Task 3 — Victim profile

CASE FILE · MR WHITE

CASE REF: PC-2026-03
DOCUMENT: Victim staff profile (extract)
DATE: Monday 17 March, morning of incident

Before the next evidence release, read the victim profile below. HR pulled this from staff records after Monday's incident. Look carefully — one detail unlocks the iPad code.

STAFF RECORD — VICTIM

NAME	ROLE
Mr James White	Year 6 class teacher
HEIGHT	BIRTHDAY
5'11"	26 July
KNOWN FOR	
Football club, strong coffee, blue desk mug	

Colleagues say Mr White is hard to miss on a Monday morning — football boots in one hand, blue coffee mug in the other. He runs the Year 6 football club on Tuesdays and still plays five-a-side with other staff on Fridays. At five foot eleven he is tall enough to reach the top shelf in the staff room cupboard without standing on a chair.

He loves coffee. Proper coffee, strong — and he takes sugar every single time, no exceptions. He always has two sugars from the staff room sugar bowl. After school he relaxes on his Xbox with his nephew — usually a football game or something they can play together on the sofa.

Mr White has taught at St Oakwood since 2019. The school nurse's last medical report lists his height as five foot eleven, his birthday as 26 July, and his age as 34. Year 6 made him a card at the summer fair when he turned thirty-four.

On Monday 17 March he filled his mug in the staff room at about 11:10, walked back to the Year 6 corridor, and left the mug on the left corner of his desk. That was the last normal moment before he collapsed later that afternoon.

FIND THE CODE

The access code is the year Mr White was born. Find his age in the profile. The case file is dated 17 March 2026. His birthday is 26 July — think about whether he has already had his birthday this year.

Mr White's age:

Case file year: 2026

Year born:

YOUR ACCESS CODE

Enter the four-digit year Mr White was born on the class iPad, then tell your teacher.

CLASS USE ONLY — DO NOT TAKE HOME

Jury declaration

POISONED COFFEE INVESTIGATION · ST OAKWOOD PRIMARY

CASE REF: PC-2026-03

DOCUMENT: Final jury verdict

DATE: Monday 17 March, morning of incident

Complete this form as a pair before the class debrief. You must name one suspect and give at least two reasons from the evidence you collected during the morning.

Group number

We, the Jury, have found _____ guilty of the
crime of poisoning Mr White's coffee.

We have reached this verdict because of this evidence:

SIGNED ON BEHALF OF THE JURY

Juror 1 (print name)

Juror 2 (print name)
